

DIGITAL CAMERAS

Developments to digital cameras in the past year continue, and prices also continue to dip. What this means is that you get better and newer features added to cameras at a certain price point. We saw some of the most unique designs and capabilities from all the participating brands in 2008 — with even cameras that were waterproof and shockproof with rugged bodies.

Like every other category of products, cameras also seem to keep getting better by the minute. Although we'd tested cameras as recently as September, we wanted to make sure that the right camera won our awards, and called for newer revisions to test.

Over 10,000

REIGNING CHAMPION

Canon Digital IXUS 85 IS

Digital IXUS is part of Canon's premium line of products. The IXUS 85 IS is one of the most compact cameras we tested in the September Digital Camera Test, and also one of the best in terms of quality. At its heart, lies a 10 MP sensor. It is a simple camera to use and its speciality is its size and design. The buttons have the right feel and the interface is easy and straight-forward to use. One complaint is that this camera lacks manual focus. The flash is strong but does not wipe out important details from the photos.

Compact camera has its own set of drawbacks and the other missing feature on this camera is a good zoom lens. The camera only comes with a 3x optical zoom lens. The pricing of the IXUS 85 IS was also a bit on the higher side but it was a lot cheaper than the other cameras of its category. It also had features matching the costlier cameras.



BEST PERFORMER / CHALLENGER

Canon PowerShot SX110

The Canon PowerShot SX110 is an improvement over the older SX100. It's also our new challenger for the Over 10,000 bracket. The SX100 was a great camera with a plethora of features. It is fair to say that it has an edge over the IXUS 85 IS in features. The SX100 was bulky and its average quality was the reason it was

n't the winning camera in the test. The new SX110 has some improvements in that aspect. It is well built and everything on the body, although made of plastic, has a sturdy feel. It also has a good quality 3-inch screen. The SX110 thus becomes an ideal contender for cameras priced over Rs 10,000. It's even more worthy as its 10x optical zoom capability takes it to the edge of the ultrazoom camera domain in a fairly compact form factor.

Other than being the Best Buy award winner of the all the point and shoot cameras we've tested, it also is the best performing one with the best of features.



great either. Even if this is an entry-level camera, some of features such as face detection have been incorporated into it.

CHALLENGER(S)

Canon PowerShot A590 IS

The Canon PowerShot A590 IS was one of the best cameras which just about fell into the high-

er price bracket with cameras priced upto Rs 16,000. The cost of an A590 IS back then was Rs 10,995 but now has dropped to just under



AND THE WINNER IS

Canon PowerShot SX110

The Canon PowerShot SX110 is the absolute winner of this award. The previous SX110 would also have been a winner if it wasn't for the below-par quality and performance. The improvements in this new version are great. At its very sensible price of just Rs 16,995, it makes both a very good performer and good value for money. Let's also remember that there are no compromises in this product

Up To Rs 10,000

REIGNING CHAMPION

Canon PowerShot A470

The Canon PowerShot A470 is part of the PowerShot 400 series which has always the entry level cameras. The A470 was the best we had under the Rs 10,000 bracket. With a price of so low, it surpasses many other cameras in its class when it comes to features and quality. Macro photography especially is simple with his camera. Whats not so great with the A470 is its age-old blocky design and a slightly outdated user interface and the video recording performance isn't so

Rs 10,000. For this price, it makes even better sense than it did back during the comparison test. In specifications, it's a lot like the A470 but has been built and designed better. It looks and feels like a point and shoot should. Some of the additional features such as manual come into his camera which the A470 lacks. In short, it's a lot better than the A470 but not the best point and shoot of all the cameras. The video recording functionality has been handicapped and the build quality is not top notch either.

AND THE WINNER IS

Canon PowerShot A590 IS

For anyone looking for a point and shoot for under Rs 10,000, there is really no need to look at anything other than the A590 IS. With its neutral colours, good crispness of photos and advanced features only found in cameras costing Rs 2,000 or so more than it. If the A470 is too simple for you and the SX100 IS too costly, then the A590 fits your requirements perfectly.

